inefficiency must be tamed. They charge that IOs have become too powerful and have evolved far past their original mandates. Populism may bring such important issues back into the public sphere for discussion (Mudde and Rovira Kaltwasser 2017). Still others, however, argue that even if populists make valid points, the solution is not to undermine or destroy existing systems of global governance but to reform them.

These issues are regularly debated, as populist parties are popular in virtually every region of the world. Figure 1.1 displays all countries with populist executives in 1990 compared with 2018; the number of populist heads of state increased from 5 to 22. More recent examples abound as well, including the 2022 election of far-right populist Giorgia Meloni as prime minister of Italy, the 2023 election of populist anarcho-capitalist Javier Milei as president of Argentina, and the 2024 reelection of Donald Trump as US president.

As a result of populism's popularity and anti-IO orientation, many have concluded that the international order is under severe duress (Copelovitch and Pevehouse 2019; Voeten 2020; Borzel and Zürn 2021). While some bemoan IOs' perceived downfall and others cheer it on, the idea that global governance faces critical challenges is generally accepted. Yet despite its importance, we know little about the nature of the populist threat to international cooperation, and how global governance is changing as a result. In this project, we take up these essential topics. In short, we conclude that the notion that populism is decimating the liberal international order is misguided; instead, we ask *how* populism is changing the global order.

To do so, we recognize that IOs have agency, and we investigate the specific strategies they adopt in response to populist attacks. We then explore how these defensive measures are altering global governance. While we discuss and briefly test how populists undermine IOs, the book focuses primarily on how IOs shift their policies as a result. Our theory is generalizable, though our empirics center primarily, but not exclusively, on international financial institutions. This concentration enables us to compare findings across empirical analyses and to speak to the large literature analyzing the effects of IOs in this realm (Stone 2011; Schneider and Tobin 2016; Lipscy 2017; Pratt 2021).

This book addresses several important scholarly debates, including how IOs can or cannot foster cooperation, the effects of the populist resurgence